Terce of the Blessed Virgin Mary

According to the Washtenaw Use



"At the hour of *Terce*, Our Lord Jesus Christ was scourged, crowned with thorns, and scorned. After His Resurrection, the same hour, He appeared to the women coming from the sepulchre. And on Pentecost Sunday, the same hour, He sent the Holy Ghost down to the Apostles and the Blessed Virgin." (Paraphrased from the *Mirror of Our Lady*.) O most Blessed Virgin, your son was rejected and most cruelly treated, but He was vindicated by His rising from the sepulchre in glory; pray that we might experience in our lives the power of His Spirit. Amen.

Before Terce

Preparatory Prayers

All kneel and pray silently. As you say the prayer Aperi, Domine*, make the sign of the cross with your thumb first over your lips, and then over your heart.*

Áperi, ✠ Dómine, os meum ad benedicéndum nomen sanctum tuum: ✠ munda quoque cor meum ab ómnibus vanis, pervérsis et aliénis cogitatiónibus; intelléctum illúmina, afféctum inflámma, ut digne, atténte ac devóte hoc Offícium beátæ Vírginis Maríæ recitáre váleam, et exaudíri mérear ante conspéctum divínæ Majestátis tuæ. Per Christum Dóminum nostrum. Amen.

Open, ✠ O Lord, my mouth to bless Thy holy Name; ✠ cleanse also my heart from all vain, evil, and wandering thoughts; enlighten my understanding and kindle my affections; that I may worthily, attentively, and devoutly say this Office of the Blessed Virgin Mary, and so merit to be heard before the presence of Thy divine Majesty. Through Christ our Lord. Amen.

Domine, in unióne illíus divínæ intentiónis, qua ipse in terris laudes Deo persolvísti, has tibi Horas persólvo.

O Lord, in union with that divine intention wherewith thou, whilst here on earth, didst render praises unto God, I desire to offer this my Office of prayer unto thee.

Ave María, grátia plena, Dóminus tecum. Benedícta tu in muliéribus, et benedíctus fructus ventris tui, Jesus. Sancta María, Mater Dei, ora pro nobis peccatóribus, nunc et in hora mortis nostræ. Amen.

Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with thee. Blessed art thou among women, and blessed is the fruit of thy womb, Jesus. Holy Mary, Mother of God, pray for us sinners, now and at the hour of our death. Amen.

Terce

Invitatory

All make the Sign of the Cross as the Officiant says the "Deus in Adjutorium". All continue together with the entire "Gloria Patri" after the response:

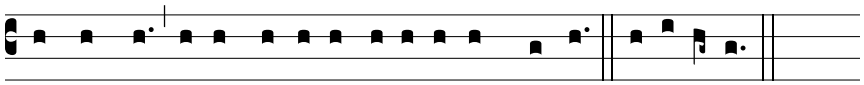


D e- us, ✠ in adju-tó-ri- um me- um inténde. ℟. Dómi-ne,

ad adju-vándum me festí-na. *(bow)* Gló-ri- a Patri, et Fí- li- o



et Spi- rí-tu- i Sancto. *(rise)* Si-cut e-rat in princí-pi- o, et nunc,



et semper et in sæcu-la sæcu-ló-rum. Amen. Alle-lú-ia.

From Septuagesima until Easter, Alleluia *is replaced with:*



Laus ti-bi Dómi-ne, Rex æ-térnæ gló-ri- æ.

O God, come to my assistance.

O Lord, make haste to help me.

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit, as it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Alleluia.

Praise to thee, O Lord, King of everlasting glory.

Hymn



For 'Throughout the Year', see page 6.

For 'Advent', see page 9.

For 'Christmastide', see page 12.

1. Remember, Maker of all things, That once the form of our flesh, From the Virgin's sacred womb, Being born, Thou didst assume.

2. Mary, Mother of grace, Sweet parent of clemency, Thou protect us from the enemy, And receive us at the hour of death.

3. Jesus, to Thee be glory, Who wast born of the Virgin, With the Father, and the loving Spirit, Unto sempiternal ages. Amen.

THROUGHOUT THE YEAR

Psalm 119

The Cantor intones the antiphon and leads the first Psalm verse to the star (*). All sit, while the Cantor's side finishes the first verse together. The Officiants side then says the second Psalm verse, with each side alternating thereafter. The remaining Psalms are intoned up to the asterisk by the Cantor, repeating the pattern of sitting and standing until the antiphon is said in full at the very end.



2. Dómine, líbera ánimam meam a lábiis in**í**quis, * et a ling*ua do***ló**sa.
3. Quid detur tibi, aut quid apponátur **ti**bi * ad ling*uam do***ló**sam?
4. Sagíttæ poténtis a**cú**tæ, * cum carbónibus de*sola***tó**riis.
5. Heu mihi! quia incolátus meus prolongátus est: † habitávi cum habitántibus **Ce**dar: * multum íncola fuit á*nima* **me**a.
6. Cum his, qui odérunt pacem, eram pa**cí**ficus: * *(stand)* cum loquébar illis, impugná*bant me* **gra**tis.
7. *(bow)* Glória Patri, et **Fí**lio, * et Spirí*tui* **Sanc**to.
8. *(rise)* Sicut erat in princípio, et nunc, et **sem**per, * et in sæcula sæcu*lórum*. **A**men.

The Virgin Mary...

1. When I was in trouble I cried unto the Lord: and he heard me.

2. O Lord, deliver my soul from wicked lips: and from a deceitful tongue.

3. What can be given to thee, or what can be superadded to thee: unto a deceitful tongue?

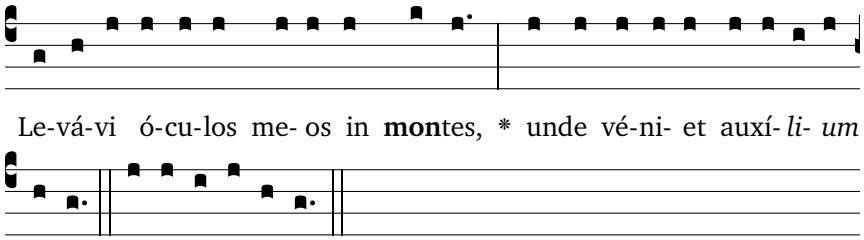
4. Sharp arrows of the mighty one: with desolating coals.

5. Woe is me, that my sojourning is prolonged! I have dwelt with the inhabitants of Cedar: my soul hath been long a sojourner.

6. With them that hated peace, I was peaceable: when I spake unto them, they fought against me without a cause.

7. Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit: As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Psalm 120



Le-vá-vi ó-cu-los me- os in **mon**tes, * unde vé-ni- et auxí- *li- um*

mi-hi. E u o u a e.

2. Auxílium meum a **Dó**mino, * qui fecit cælum *et* **ter**ram.
3. Non det in commotiónem pedem **tu**um: * neque dormítet *qui cus***tó**dit te.
4. Ecce, non dormitábit neque **dór**miet, * qui cus*tódit* **Is**raël.
5. Dóminus custódit te, Dóminus protéctio **tu**a, * super manum déx*teram* **tu**am.
6. Per diem sol non **u**ret te: * neque lu*na per* **noc**tem.
7. Dóminus custódit te ab omni **ma**lo: * custódiat ánimam *tuam* **Dó**minus.
8. Dóminus custódiat intróitum tuum, et éxitum **tu**um: * *(stand)* ex hoc nunc, et us*que in* **sæ**culum.
9. *(bow)* Glória Patri, et **Fí**lio, * et Spirítui **Sanc**to.
10. *(rise)* Sicut erat in princípio, et nunc, et **sem**per, * et in sæcula sæcu*lórum*. **A**men.

1. I have lifted up mine eyes unto the hills: from whence shall come my help.

2. My help is in the Lord: who hath made heaven and earth.

3. Let him not suffer thy foot to be moved: neither let him sleep that keepeth thee.

4. Behold, he shall neither slumber nor sleep: that keepeth Israel.

5. The Lord is thy keeper, the Lord is thy defense: upon thy right hand.

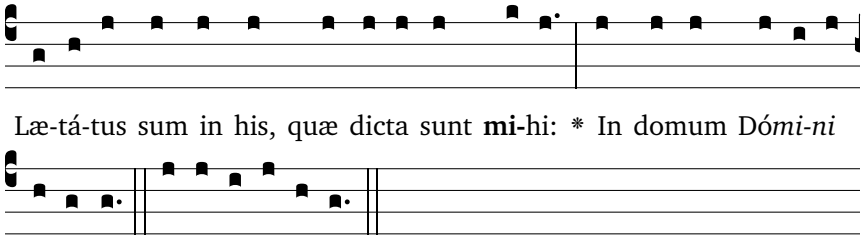
6. The sun shall not burn thee by day: nor the moon by night.

7. The Lord preserveth thee from all evil: may the Lord preserve thy soul.

8. May the Lord preserve thy coming in and thy going out: from this time forth forever more.

9. Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit: As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Psalm 121



Læ-tá-tus sum in his, quæ dicta sunt **mi**-hi: * In domum Dó*mi-ni*

í-bimus. E u o u a e.

2. Stantes erant pedes **nos**tri, * in átriis tu*is*, *Je***rú**salem.
3. Jerúsalem, quæ ædificátur ut **cí**vitas: * cujus participátio ejus *in id***íp**sum.
4. Illuc enim ascendérunt tribus, tribus **Dó**mini: * testimónium Israël ad confiténdum nó*mini* **Dó**mini.
5. Quia illic sedérunt sedes in ju**dí**cio, * sedes super *domum* **Da**vid.

1. I was glad at the things that were said unto me: We will go into the house of the Lord.

2. Our feet were wont to stand: in thy courts, O Jerusalem.

3. Jerusalem, which is built as a city: that is at unity with itself.

4. For thither did the tribes go up, the tribes of the Lord: the testimony of Israel, to praise the Name of the Lord.

5. For there are set the seats of judgment: the seats over the house of David.

6. Pray ye for the things that are

6. Rogáte quæ ad pacem sunt Je**rú**salem: * et abundántia dilig*énti***bus** te:

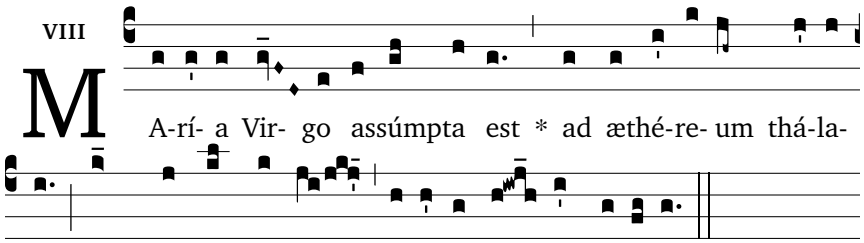
7. Fiat pax in virtúte **tu**a: * et abundántia in túr*ribus* **tu**is.

8. Propter fratres meos, et próximos **me**os, * loquébar *pacem* **de** te:

9. Propter domum Dómini, Dei **nos**tri, * *(stand)* quæsívi *bona* **ti**bi.

10. *(bow)* Glória Patri, et **Fí**lio, * et Spirítui **Sanc**to.

11. *(rise)* Sicut erat in princípio, et nunc, et **sem**per, * et in sæcula sæcul*órum*. **A**men.



mum, in quo Rex re-gum stellá-to se- det só-li- o.

Proceed to page 15.

for the peace of Jerusalem: and plenteousness be to them that love thee.

7. Let peace be in thy strength: and plenteousness in thy towers.

8. For my brethren and companions' sake: I spake peace concerning thee.

9. Because of the house of the Lord our God: I have sought good things for thee.

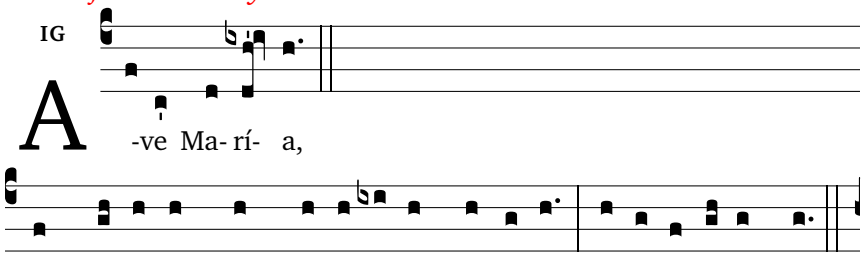
10. Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit: As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

The Virgin Mary was taken up to the heavenly chamber, where the King of kings sitteth on his starry throne.

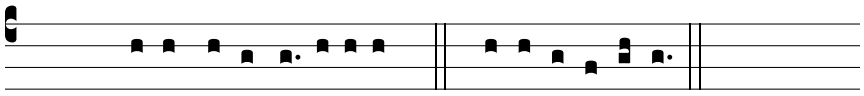
ADVENT

Psalm 119

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Ad Dómi-num cum tri-bu-**lá-**rer cla**má-**vi: * et *exau***dí-**vit me.



Flex: pro-longá-tus est: E u o u a e.

2. Dómine, líbera ánimam meam a lábi**is** iníquis, * et a ling*ua do***ló**sa.
3. Quid detur tibi, aut quid appo**ná**tur **ti**bi * ad ling*uam do***ló**sam?
4. Sagíttæ pot**én**tis a**cú**tæ, * cum carbónibus de*sola***tó**riis.
5. Heu mihi! quia incolátus meus prolongátus est: † habitávi cum habi**tán**tibus **Ce**dar: * multum íncola fuit *ánima* **me**a.
6. Cum his, qui odérunt pacem, **e**ram pa**cí**ficus: * *(stand)* cum loquébar illis, impugná*bant me* **gra**tis.
7. *(bow)* Glória **Pa**tri, et **Fí**lio, * et Spirí*tui* **Sanc**to.
8. *(rise)* Sicut erat in princípio, et **nunc**, et **sem**per, * et in sæcula sæcu*lórum*. **A**men.

Hail Mary...

1. When I was in trouble I cried unto the Lord: and he heard me.

2. O Lord, deliver my soul from wicked lips: and from a deceitful tongue.

3. What can be given to thee, or what can be superadded to thee: unto a deceitful tongue?

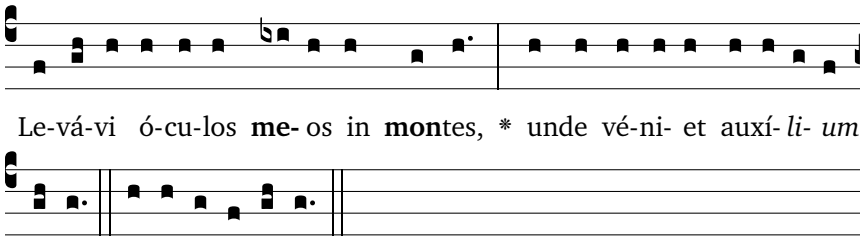
4. Sharp arrows of the mighty one: with desolating coals.

5. Woe is me, that my sojourning is prolonged! I have dwelt with the inhabitants of Cedar: my soul hath been long a sojourner.

6. With them that hated peace, I was peaceable: when I spake unto them, they fought against me without a cause.

7. Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit: As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Psalm 120



Le-vá-vi ó-cu-los **me-** os in **mon**tes, * unde vé-ni- et auxí- *li- um*

mi-hi. E u o u a e.

2. Auxílium **me**um a **Dó**mino, * qui fecit cæ*lum et* **ter**ram.
3. Non det in commotiónem **pe**dem **tu**um: * neque dormítet *qui cus***tó**dit te.
4. Ecce, non dormitábit **ne**que **dór**miet, * qui cus*tódit* **Is**raël.
5. Dóminus custódit te, Dóminus pro**téc**tio **tu**a, * super manum dex*teram* **tu**am.
6. Per diem **sol** non **u**ret te: * neque lu*na per* **noc**tem.
7. Dóminus custódit te ab **om**ni **ma**lo: * custódiat ánimam *tuam* **Dó**minus.
8. Dóminus custódiat intróitum tuum, et **éx**itum **tu**um: * *(stand)* ex hoc nunc, et us*que in* **sæ**culum.
9. *(bow)* Glória **Pa**tri, et **Fí**lio, * et Spirítui **Sanc**to.
10. *(rise)* Sicut erat in princípio, et **nunc**, et **sem**per, * et in sæcula sæcu*lórum*. **A**men.

1. *I have lifted up mine eyes unto the hills: from whence shall come my help.*
2. *My help is in the Lord: who hath made heaven and earth.*
3. *Let him not suffer thy foot to be moved: neither let him sleep that keepeth thee.*
4. *Behold, he shall neither slumber nor sleep: that keepeth Israel.*
5. *The Lord is thy keeper, the Lord is thy defense: upon thy right hand.*
6. *The sun shall not burn thee by day: nor the moon by night.*
7. *The Lord preserveth thee from all evil: may the Lord preserve thy soul.*
8. *May the Lord preserve thy coming in and thy going out: from this time forth forever more.*
9. *Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit: As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.*

Psalm 121



Læ-tá-tus sum in his, quæ **dic**ta sunt **mi-**hi: * In domum Dó*mi-ni*

í-bimus. E u o u a e.

2. Stantes erant **pe**des **nos**tri, * in átriis tu*is*, *Je***rú**salem.
3. Jerúsalem, quæ ædifi**cá**tur ut **cí**vitas: * cujus participátio ejus *in id***íp**sum.
4. Illuc enim ascendérunt tribus, **tri**bus **Dó**mini: * testimónium Israël ad confiténdum nó*mini* **Dó**mini.
5. Quia illic sedérunt sedes **in** ju**dí**cio, * sedes super *domum* **Da**vid.

1. *I was glad at the things that were said unto me: We will go into the house of the Lord.*
2. *Our feet were wont to stand: in thy courts, O Jerusalem.*
3. *Jerusalem, which is built as a city: that is at unity with itself.*
4. *For thither did the tribes go up, the tribes of the Lord: the testimony of Israel, to praise the Name of the Lord.*
5. *For there are set the seats of judgement: the seats over the house of David.*
6. *Pray ye for the things that are*

6. Rogáte quæ ad pacem **sunt** Je**rú**salem: * et abundántia dili*génti***bus** te:

7. Fiat pax in vir**tú**te **tu**a: * et abundántia in túr*ribus* **tu**is.

8. Propter fratres meos, et **pró**ximos **me**os, * loquébar *pacem* **de** te:

9. Propter domum Dómini, **De**i **nos**tri, * *(stand)* quæsívi *bona* **ti**bi.

10. *(bow)* Glória **Pa**tri, et **Fí**lio, * et Spirí*tui* **Sanc**to.

11. *(rise)* Sicut erat in princípio, et **nunc**, et **sem**per, * et in sǽcula sæcul*órum*. **A**men.



Proceed to page 15.

for the peace of Jerusalem: and plenteousness be to the them that love thee.

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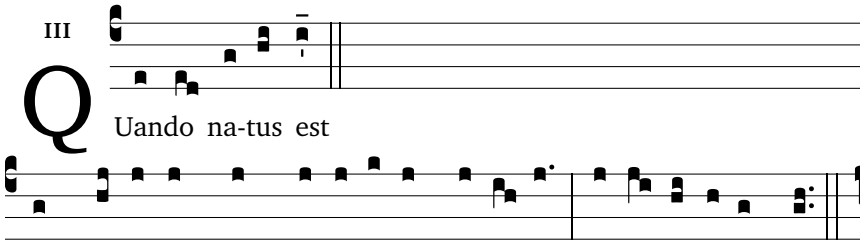
10. Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit: As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Hail Mary, full of grace, the Lord is with thee. Blessed art thou amongst women. Alleluia.

CHRISTMASTIDE

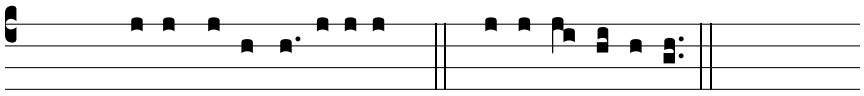
Psalm 119

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When Thou wast born...

Ad Dómi-num cum tri-bu-**lá**-rer cla**má**-vi: * et *ex-au***dí**-vit me.



Flex: pro-longá-tus est: E u o u a e.

2. Dómine, líbera ánimam meam a lábi**is** iníquis, * et a ling*ua do***ló**sa.
3. Quid detur tibi, aut quid appo**ná**tur **ti**bi * ad ling*uam do***ló**sam?
4. Sagíttæ pot**én**tis a**cú**tæ, * cum carbónibus de*sola***tó**riis.
5. Heu mihi! quia incolátus meus prolongátus est: † habitávi cum habi**tán**tibus **Ce**dar: * multum íncola fuit *ánima* **me**a.
6. Cum his, qui odérunt pacem, **e**ram pa**cífi**cus: * *(stand)* cum loquébar illis, impugn*ábant me* **gra**tis.
7. *(bow)* Glória **Pa**tri, et **Fíli**o, * et Spir*ítui* **Sanc**to.
8. *(rise)* Sicut erat in princípio, et **nunc**, et **sem**per, * et in sæcula sæcul*órum*. **A**men.

1. When I was in trouble I cried unto the Lord: and he heard me.

2. O Lord, deliver my soul from wicked lips: and from a deceitful tongue.

3. What can be given to thee, or what can be superadded to thee: unto a deceitful tongue?

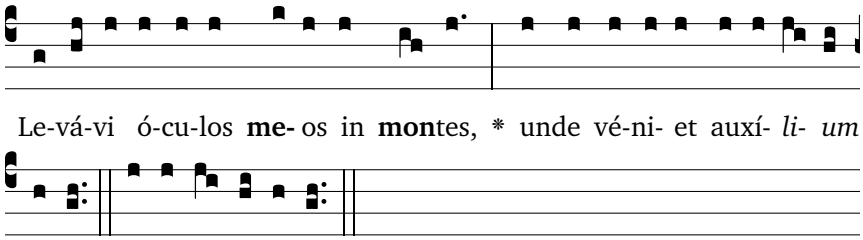
4. Sharp arrows of the mighty one: with desolating coals.

5. Woe is me, that my sojourning is prolonged! I have dwelt with the inhabitants of Cedar: my soul hath been long a sojourner.

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7. Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit: As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

Psalm 120



Le-vá-vi ó-cu-los **me-** os in **mon**tes, * unde vé-ni- et auxí- *li- um*

mi-hi. E u o u a e.

2. Auxílium **me**um a **Dómi**no, * qui fecit cæ*lum et* **ter**ram.
3. Non det in commotiónem **pe**dem **tu**um: * neque dormítet *qui cus***tó**dit te.
4. Ecce, non dormitábit **ne**que **dórmi**et, * qui cus*tódit* **Is**raël.
5. Dóminus custódit te, Dóminus pro**téc**tio **tu**a, * super manum déx*teram* **tu**am.
6. Per diem **sol** non **uret** te: * neque lu*na per* **noc**tem.
7. Dóminus custódit te ab **om**ni **ma**lo: * custódiat ánimam *tuam* **Dó**minus.
8. Dóminus custódiat intróitum tuum, et **éx**itum **tu**um: * *(stand)* ex hoc nunc, et us*que in* **sæ**culum.
9. *(bow)* Glória **Pa**tri, et **Fíli**o, * et Spirítui **Sanc**to.
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3. Let him not suffer thy foot to be moved: neither let him sleep that keepeth thee.

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Psalm 121



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3. Jerusalem, which is built as a city: that is at unity with itself.

4. For thither did the tribes go up, the tribes of the Lord: the testimony of Israel, to praise the Name of the Lord.

5. For there are set the seats of judgement: the seats over the house of David.

6. Pray ye for the things that are

6. Rogáte quæ ad pacem **sunt** Je**rúsa**lem: * et abundántia dili*génti***bus** te:

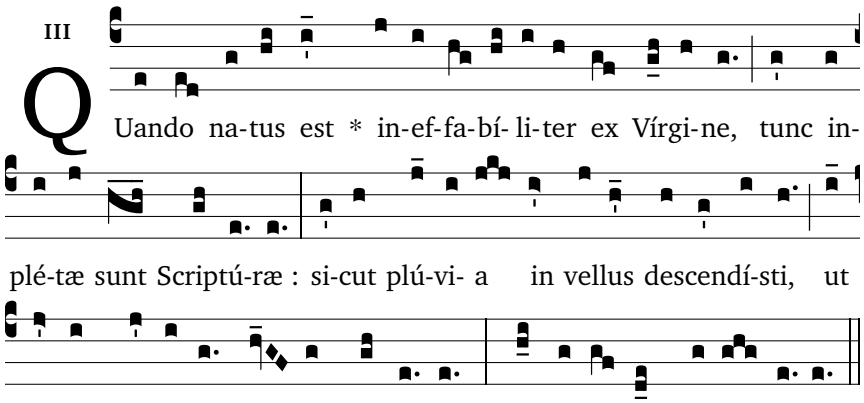
7. Fiat pax in vir**tú**te **tu**a: * et abundántia in túr*ribus* **tu**is.

8. Propter fratres meos, et **pró**ximos **me**os, * loquébar *pacem* **de** te:

9. Propter domum Dómini, **De**i **nos**tri, * *(stand)* quæsívi *bona* **ti**bi.

10. *(bow)* Glória **Pa**tri, et **Fíli**o, * et Spirítui **Sanc**to.

11. *(rise)* Sicut erat in princípio, et **nunc**, et **sem**per, * et in sǽcula sæcu*lórum*. **A**men.



Proceed to the next page.

for the peace of Jerusalem: and plenteousness be to the them that love thee.

7. Let peace be in thy strength: and plenteousness in thy towers.

8. For my brethren and companions' sake: I spake peace concerning thee.

9. Because of the house of the Lord our God: I have sought good things for thee.

10. Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Spirit: As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be, world without end. Amen.

When Thou wast born of a Virgin, after an ineffable manner, then were the Scriptures fulfilled. Thou didst come down like rain upon the fleece, that thou mightest save mankind: we praise thee, O our God.

The Little Chapter

The Officiant leads the Little Chapter, which varies according to the season:

Throughout the Year and in Christmastide: Sirach 24:15

Et sic in Sion firmata sum, † et in civitate sanctificata similiter *requi***e**vi, et in Jerusalem potestas mea.

℟. Deo gratias.
℣. Diffusa est gratia in labiis tuis.
℟. Propterea benedixit te Deus in æternum.
℣. Domine, exaudi orationem meam.
℟. Et clamor meus ad te veniat.

And so was I established in Sion, and in the holy city likewise I rested, and my power was in Jerusalem.

℟. *Thanks be to God.*
℣. *Grace was poured forth on thy lips.*
℟. *Therefore hath God blessed thee forever.*
℣. *O Lord, hear my prayer.*
℟. *And let my cry come unto thee.*

In Advent: Isaiah 11:1-2

Egredietur virga de radice Jesse, † et flos de radice e*jus as***cen**det. Et requiescet super eum Spiritus Domini.

℟. Deo gratias.
℣. Diffusa est gratia in labiis tuis.
℟. Propterea benedixit te Deus in æternum.
℣. Domine, exaudi orationem meam.
℟. Et clamor meus ad te veniat.

There shall come forth a shoot from the stump of Jesse, and a branch shall grow out of his roots. And the Spirit of the Lord shall rest upon him.

℟. *Thanks be to God.*
℣. *Grace was poured forth on thy lips.*
℟. *Therefore hath God blessed thee forever.*
℣. *O Lord, hear my prayer.*
℟. *And let my cry come unto thee.*

Collect

The Officiant leads the concluding collect, which differs depending on the season:

Throughout the Year and in Christmastide:

Orémus. Deus, qui salutis ætérnæ, beatæ Maríæ virginitate foecunda, humano generi præmia præstitisti: † tribue, quæsumus; ut ipsam pro nobis intercedere *senti***a**mus, per quam meruimus auctorem vitæ suscipere, * Dominum nostrum Jesum Christum, Filium tuum. Qui tecum vivit et regnat in unitate Spiritu Sancti Deus, per omnia sæcula sæculórum.

℟. Amen.

Let us pray. O God, who, by the fruitful virginity of the Blessed Mary, has given to mankind the rewards of eternal salvation; grant, we beseech Thee, that we may be sensible of her intercession, through whom we have received the author of life, Our Lord Jesus Christ, Thy Son. Who liveth and reigneth in the unity of the Holy Spirit, world without end.

℟. *Amen.*

In Advent:

Orémus. Deus, qui de beatæ Maríæ Virginis utero Verbum tuum, Angelo nuntiante, carnem suscipere voluisti: † præsta supplicibus tuis, ut qui vere eam Genitricem De*i cre***di**mus, ejus apud te intercessionibus adjuvemur. * Per eumdem Dominum nostrum Jesum Christum filium tuum, Qui tecum vivit et regnat in unitate Spiritu Sancti Deus, per omnia sæcula sæculórum.

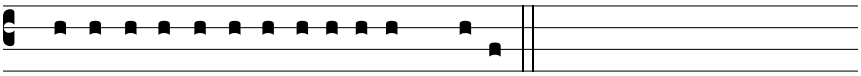
℟. Amen.

Let us pray. O God, who wast pleased that Thy Word, at the message of an Angel, should take flesh in the womb of the Blessed Virgin Mary; grant to us, Thy humble servants, that, as we believe her to be truly the Mother of God, we may be assisted also by her intercessions with Thee. Through the same Lord Jesus Christ Thy Son, Who liveth and reigneth with Thee in the unity of the Holy Spirit, world without end.

℟. *Amen.*

Conclusion

The Officiant leads the conclusion; the Benedicamus is that of the common tone, except when during Paschal time:

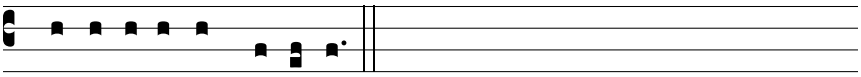


℣. Domi-ne exaudi o-ra-ti- ónem me- am.

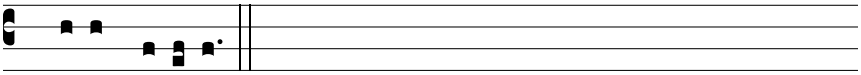


℟. Et clamor me- us ad te vé-ni- at.

℣. O Lord, hear my prayer. ℟. And let my cry come unto thee.



℣. Be-ne-di-cámus Dómi-no.



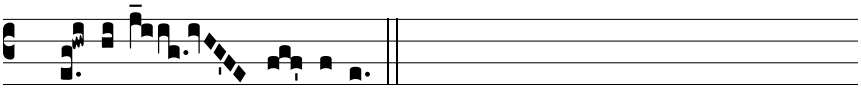
℟. De- o grá-ti- as.

℣. Let us bless the Lord. ℟. Thanks be to God.

In Paschal Time:



℣. Be-ne-di-cámus Dó- mi-no.



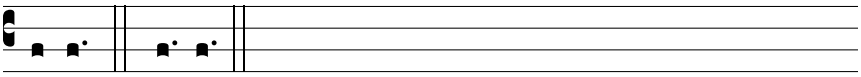
℟. Dé- o grá- ti- as.

℣. Let us bless the Lord. ℟. Thanks be to God.

The Officiant says the following in a low recto tono:



℣. Fi-dé-li- um á-nimæ per mi-se-ri-córdi- am De- i, requi- éscant in



pa-ce- . ℟. Amen.

℣. May the souls of the faithful departed, through the mercy of God, rest in peace. ℟. Amen.

Appendix

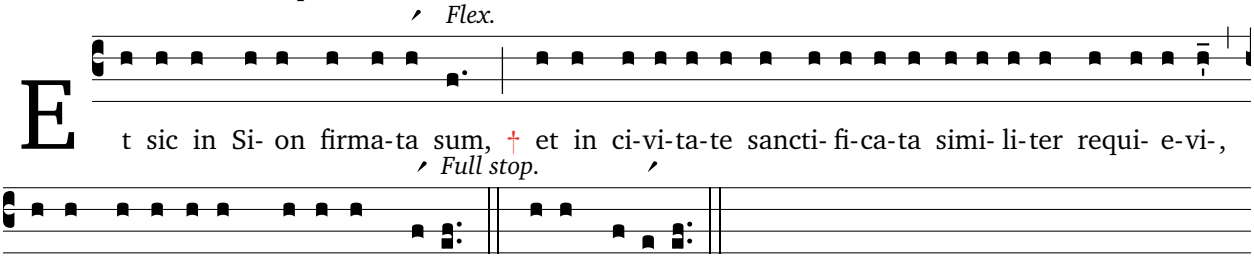
Below is a brief guide for chanting the Little Chapter and the Collect. Due to the solemnity of the mystery it celebrates, the Office of the Blessed Virgin Mary is treated as a "perpetual feast". Accordingly, the Festive Tone (*Tonus Festivus*) is always used for both the Little Chapter and the Collect. Examples are shown below.

Tone for the Little Chapter

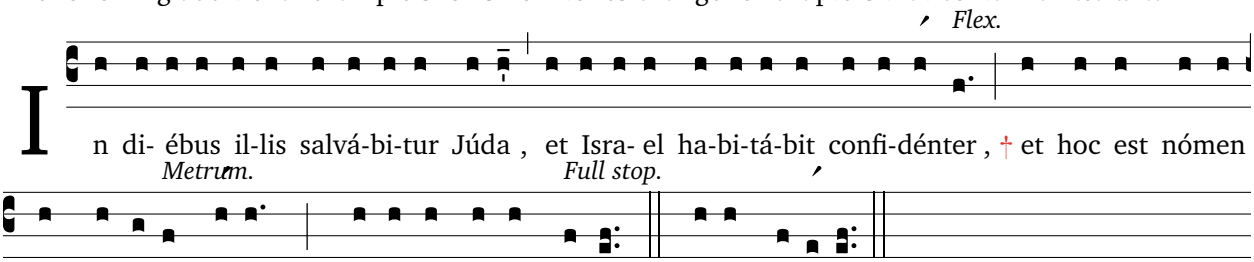
For the Little Chapter, the tone involves recitation *almost entirely* on a single reciting pitch (i.e. *recto tono*), with a few exceptions:

1. If a mid-sentence breath is marked by a *flex* (signified by a "†" or a ";") the tone drops down a **minor third**.
2. There is *no change of tone* when the phrase arrives at a comma.
3. For sufficiently long chapters that include a *metrum* (which breaks a phrase with a "*"), the tones descend with a half step, followed by a whole step, before returning to the reciting tone.
4. At the end of the phrase (the *termination*), the tone drops a minor third, then drops a whole step, and then rises a whole step. This pattern is imitated in the "Déo grátias" response immediately after.

Please refer to the example below:



The following additional example shows how tones change for chapters that contain a *metrum*:

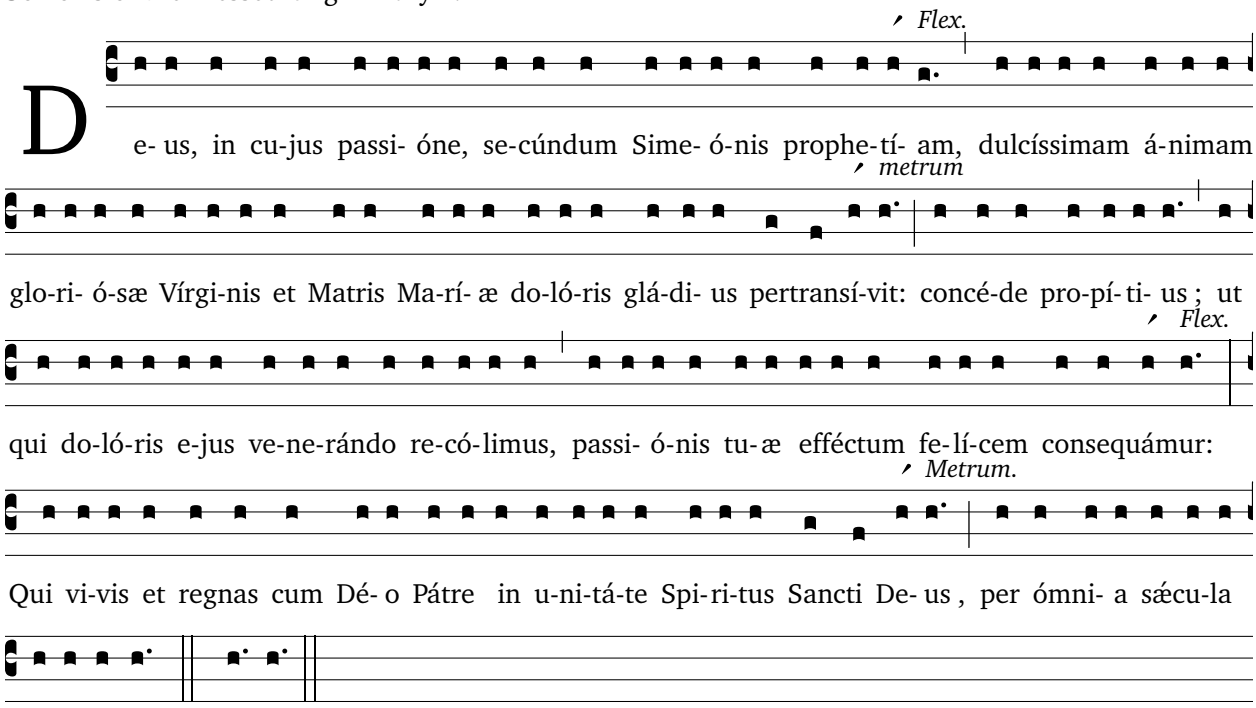


For more information, please see the relevant section [1] within the portion of the Liber Usualis entitled 'The Ordinary Chants of the Office'.

[1] *Liber Usualis, 1961 Solesmes Edition, "Tone for the Chapter", page 123.*

Tone for the Collect

For the Collect, there are minor differences in the manner of reciting the tones that essentially constitute additional embellishments over the approach of the Little Chapter. Everything is the same as the approach for the Little Chapter, except that arrivals at a comma or colon *are* treated as *flexa*. In this case, the tone drops a half step, as shown in the following example for the proper Mass of the Seven Sorrows of the Blessed Virgin Mary [2]:



Note in this example above, there is *not* a second metrum immediately after the word “propítius” due to the sense of the passage; essentially, the cadence of the collect would be unduly prolonged by introducing a metrum immediately following a preceding one (which in this case is at the conclusion of the word “pertransívit”).

[2] *ibid.“Tones for the Prayers”, pg. 124 & “Tones for the Prayers”; 1. Festal Tone., pg. 98*